Getting Started

The file `python_course.zip` on Moodle contains all the files you need for the course.

Everything is also available on the course GitHub repository

All the course files are Jupyter Notebooks, identified by the `.ipynb` extension.

Working with Notebooks

You'll need to have a way to open these on your own computer. There are two main ways to do this:

1. Use an online platform, like Google Colab (no installation required). You have access to this via your University Google account. You just need to extract the contents of `python_course.zip` into a folder in your Google Drive, then the `.ipynb` files should just open in Colab.
2. Install python on your computer (installation required. If you plan to do things with Python in future (e.g. in your project), this is worth spending some time setting up now. There are few ways to do this. One of the most straightforward is to use Anaconda, which provides an 'out of the box' python environment with lots of common scientific packages. This is a good place to start, and you can see detailed installation instructions here. This will allow you to run the notebooks on your own computer. First, extract `python_course.zip` into a folder on your computer. Then open the 'Anaconda Navigator' program and launch JupyterLab. Once in Jupyter, navigate to python course folder the on your computer, and you will be able to access the notebooks.

There are many other ways to interact with Python notebooks. For example, VSCode and PyCharm are two common ones. Ask in the sessions if you'd like to find out more about using these.